

Would you check whether this is accurate — and whether I can legally offer it?

A free tool that answers wage-and-hour questions using only the text of the law

From Clinton Egger · clinton.mcclain@gmail.com · August 18, 2026

Please write directly on this page. Partial answers are welcome — even one is useful.

I have built a tool that answers questions about pay, hours and leave. It does not give opinions. It reads the actual regulations, and every statement it makes has to quote the words it comes from — the quote is checked against the official source automatically, and anything that does not match exactly is thrown away before the reader sees it.

It holds the federal wage and hour regulations (29 CFR parts 541, 778, 785, 531, 795 and 825, as published 4 August 2026) and, for Texas, the Texas Workforce Commission's published guidance on the Payday Law. It has no Texas statutes, because the Legislature's website does not make them available in a form software can read. When a question falls outside what it holds, it refuses and names the body of law that governs instead.

Nobody with legal training has looked at any of it. That is what I am asking for. I cannot pay for this, so please treat it as a favour and answer only what is quick.

Three real answers, exactly as it produced them

Sample 1 — “My employer pays me a salary and says that means I never get overtime. Is that right?”

SAYS IT ANSWERS PART OF THE QUESTION 4 points, each quoting a source

It told the reader: This law tells you being paid a salary is not enough by itself to lose overtime — you also need to meet a duties test and salary-level test for one of the specific exemptions; a full check of your specific job duties against those exemptions is fact-specific and beyond what a general answer can settle.

Being called 'salaried' or having any job title does not by itself decide whether you get overtime. What matters is whether your actual pay and job duties meet the specific legal requirements for an exemption.

“A job title alone is insufficient to establish the exempt status of an employee. The exempt or nonexempt status of any particular employee must be determined on the basis of whether the employee's salary and duties meet the requirements of the regulations in this part.”

29 CFR 541.2

To be exempt as an executive, administrative, or professional employee, you must be paid at least \$684/week on a salary basis AND your actual job duties must meet detailed tests — simply being paid a salary is not enough.

“Compensated on a salary basis pursuant to § 541.600 at a rate of not less than \$684 per week (or \$455 per week if employed in the Commonwealth of the Northern Mariana Islands, Guam, Puerto Rico, or the U.S. Virgin Islands by employers other than the Federal government, or \$380 per week if employed in American Samoa by employers other than the Federal government), exclusive of board, lodging or other facilities;”

29 CFR 541.100

Manual laborers and other 'blue collar' workers cannot be exempt from overtime no matter how they are paid or how highly paid they are, even if they are paid a salary.

“Such nonexempt “blue collar” employees gain the skills and knowledge required for performance of their routine manual and physical work through apprenticeships and on-the-job training, not through the prolonged course of specialized intellectual instruction required for exempt learned professional employees such as medical doctors, architects and archeologists.”

29 CFR 541.3

If your employer improperly takes money out of your salary in ways not allowed under the rules, you could lose the exemption entirely and be owed overtime even though you're paid a salary.

“An employer who makes improper deductions from salary shall lose the exemption if the facts demonstrate that the employer did not intend to pay employees on a salary basis.”

29 CFR 541.603

Sample 2 — “I quit my job last week and my employer still has not given me my final paycheck. How long do they have?”

SAYS IT ANSWERS PART OF THE QUESTION 3 points, each quoting a source

It told the reader: This answer relies on the Texas Workforce Commission's published guidance about the Texas Payday Law, not the text of the statute itself, which is not available here; the actual Texas Labor Code provisions on final wages are not shown above.

Because you quit, your employer has until your next regularly scheduled payday to pay your final wages — not six days like someone who is fired or laid off.

“Quit / Resign / Retire: Final payment is due on the next regularly scheduled payday after the effective date of resignation.”

TWC Payday Law — Final Wages AGENCY GUIDANCE, NOT STATUTE

This rule about final pay timing comes from the state agency's guidance on the Texas Payday Law, not from the federal law shown above.

“The deadline to pay the employee’s final wages is listed below.”

TWC Payday Law — Final Wages AGENCY GUIDANCE, NOT STATUTE

If your employer still misses that payday, you can file a wage claim with TWC, but you must do it within 180 days of when the wages were originally due.

“The deadline for filing a wage claim is no later than 180 days after the date the wages were originally due to be paid.”

TWC Payday Law — How to File a Wage Claim AGENCY GUIDANCE, NOT STATUTE

Sample 3 — “My manager fired me after I told him I was pregnant. Can I sue?”

DECLINES TO ANSWER

It told the reader: Firing someone because they are pregnant is a discrimination question, not a wage-or-hours question — it falls under Title VII of the Civil Rights Act (as amended by the Pregnancy Discrimination Act) and is handled by the U.S. Equal Employment Opportunity Commission, not by the wage-and-hour rules in the materials I have.

No points were given. The tool said this is outside wage-and-hour law and named the law that does cover it.

What I would most like to know

1. Are the three answers above correct?

Mark anything wrong directly on them. A cross in the margin is enough.

2. Would any of them lead someone to do the wrong thing — miss a deadline, waive something, not file a claim?

This worries me more than being merely incomplete.

3. Sample 2 quotes the Texas Workforce Commission rather than the Texas Labor Code, because I cannot obtain the statute. It is labelled “agency guidance, not statute.” Is that acceptable, and is the label enough?

4. For Texas, the tool treats federal law as the full answer on overtime, exemptions, hours worked and tips, and treats pay frequency, final paychecks and deductions as governed by Texas law. Is that split right?

5. If I make this freely available to the public in Texas, is that the unauthorised practice of law?

The single question that decides whether this exists at all.

6. If it is a problem, what would have to change? Different wording, a different disclaimer, refusing certain kinds of question, or is there no version of this that works?

7. What kind of question would you least want it to attempt?

I can make it refuse whole categories. I would rather know which ones from you than guess.

8. Anything else that made you wince.

Prepared August 18, 2026. Please return marked up, or reply to clinton.mcclain@gmail.com.